

AN INDEPENDENT REVIEW OF PUBLICLY AVAILABLE RECORDS

What the Minutes Say

Thirty Years of National Speleological Society Board of Governors Records, 1996–2026

Presented by Aaron Bird

NSS Fellow · NSS #27029

Records collected 22–24 September 2026 (UTC) · Facts as of 24 September 2026



Not an official NSS presentation. Every fact comes from pages reachable without any login.

Three ground rules

1

Public only

Every document was retrieved from a public web address with no login, no account and no cookies. Member-only material (for example NSS News) is excluded and handled in a separate, clearly labelled effort.

2

Descriptive

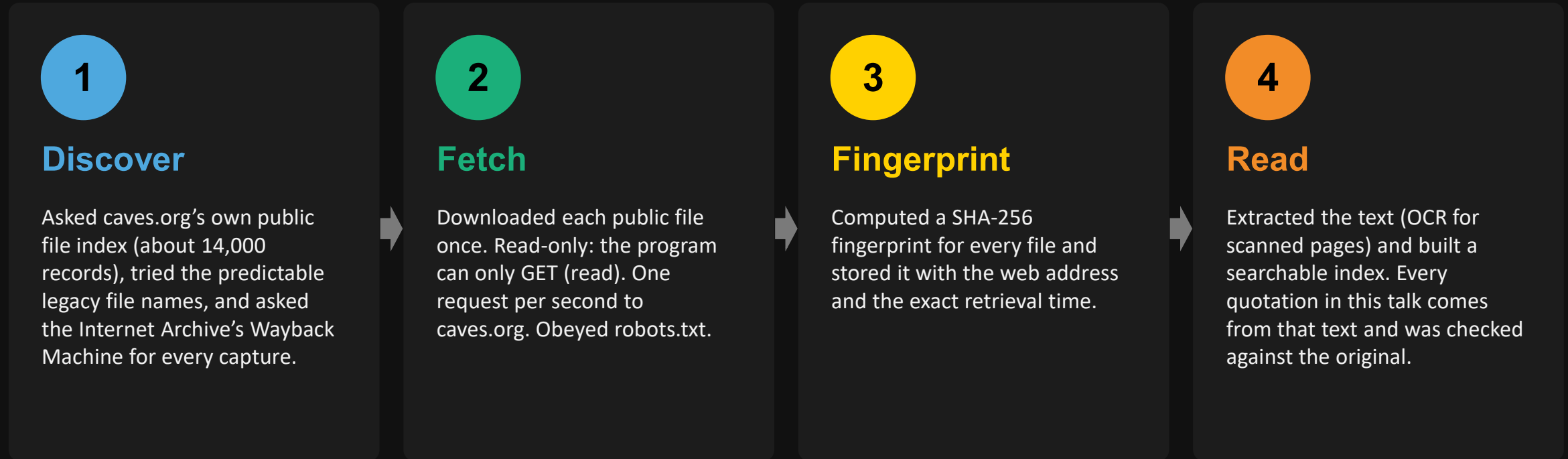
The talk reports what the records say and what they do not say. It does not assign motives. Where a record is a draft, it is labelled as a draft.

3

Traceable

Each slide carries its source. Speaker notes and the appendix give full web links. Every file has a SHA-256 fingerprint and a retrieval time in a manifest.

How the investigation worked



Collection	Date collected (UTC)
Minutes, agendas, officer reports	22 Sep 2026
Acts, Bylaws, Board Manuals · public financial records · IRS data	23 Sep 2026
Executive Director role documents	24 Sep 2026

What the Society's server saw when my program knocked

The request my program sent (every request looked like this)

```
GET /wp-content/uploads/2026/08/2026.06.29_NSS-BoG-Special-
Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf HTTP/1.1
Host: caves.org
User-Agent: NSS-BOG-Minutes-Archiver/1.0 (one-time, read-only
crawl of publicly posted NSS Board of Governors minutes,
agendas and reports; operator: Aaron Bird, NSS Fellow, NSS
#27029; contact: 2dbatk@gmail.com)
From: 2dbatk@gmail.com
Accept: */*
```

No cookies, no login, no password. The name and email travel with every request, so they appear in the Society's own web-server logs.

What my program wrote in its own log

```
2026-09-22 20:11:41 UTC
```

```
GET https://caves.org/robots.txt
```

```
200 OK · 37 bytes
```

Reads the site's rules for automated visitors first

```
2026-09-22 20:42:52 UTC
```

```
GET .../2026/08/2026.06.29_NSS-BoG-Special-
Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf
```

```
200 OK
```

Downloads the 29 June 2026 draft minutes (77,769 bytes)

What the program actually reads: HTML, JSON and XML

HTML — a 2003 NSS web page listing minutes

```
<h1 align="center"><font
face="Arial">Minutes of Board of
Governors Meetings</font></h1>

<p><font size="4">Minutes for the </font><a
href="minutes/mar03bog.html"><font
size="4">March 15, 2003</font></a><font
size="4"> Board of Governors
Meeting</font></p>

<p><font size="4">Minutes for the </font><a
href="minutes/oct02bog.html"><font
size="4">October 5, 2002</font></a> ...
```

JSON — caves.org's own file index

```
{
  "id": 45228,
  "date": "2026-08-16T11:33:05",
  "modified": "2026-08-16T11:33:05",
  "title": "2026.06.29_NSS BoG Special
            Meeting Minutes_Draft 1",
  "mime_type": "application/pdf",
  "source_url": "https://caves.org/
wp-content/uploads/2026/08/
2026.06.29_NSS-BoG-Special-
Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf"
}
```

"date" is when the file was uploaded to the website.

XML — the Society's Form 990 as filed with the IRS

```
<ReturnHeader>
  <TaxPeriodEndDt>2024-03-
31</TaxPeriodEndDt>
  ...
</ReturnHeader>
...
<MinutesOfGoverningBodyInd>
  false
</MinutesOfGoverningBodyInd>
<MinutesOfCommitteesInd>
  false
</MinutesOfCommitteesInd>
```

Part VI, line 8a–8b of the FY2024 return, exactly as stored by the IRS.

METHOD

SHA-256: a fingerprint for every file

Feed any file or text into SHA-256 and out comes a 64-character fingerprint. Change a single character and the fingerprint changes completely. It cannot be run backwards, and no one has found a way to make two different files with the same fingerprint.

Original sentence

"The Board voted unanimously to terminate the Executive Director's contract without cause."

cd0d0e69975f63cdf4c655b4a51ce0df36764d58f5e280e1611eb27d5e788902

One word removed

"The Board voted to terminate the Executive Director's contract without cause."

e4dc5371bf1418e2640c9a6e0ea88c0d3aa622197fc259b3c535e8b67dea9978

Final period removed

"The Board voted unanimously to terminate the Executive Director's contract without cause"

f61f670aa7fc5b43439434088dc42efc24a99f8590e7bc6c8b5bd9f0ab52a3ac

The 29 June 2026 draft minutes, as collected on 22 Sep 2026: **2ce174bc52aca1ce5422e94a3aa10a088766e8ddfc9ad5fb578c99ccb79a3cdc**
Check it yourself — Windows: certutil -hashfile <file> SHA256 · Mac/Linux: shasum -a 256 <file>

See it for yourself — no login required

1

The site's rules for automated visitors

<https://caves.org/robots.txt>

2

The Society's public file index (search "BOG")

https://caves.org/wp-json/wp/v2/media?search=BOG&per_page=20

3

The "Board Minutes" collection of Business Documents

<https://caves.org/collection/board-minutes/>

4

A set of minutes — 29 June 2026 draft

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/2026.06.29_NSS-BoG-Special-Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf

5

An NSS index page of minutes, as saved in 2003

<https://web.archive.org/web/20030723204012/http://ftp.caves.org/nss-business/bog-minutes.html>

Minutes of Board of Governors Meetings

Minutes for the [March 15, 2003](#) Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [October 5, 2002](#) Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [June 24 & 28, 2002](#) Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [March 23, 2002](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [October 20, 2001](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [June 23 & 27, 2001](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [April 7, 2001](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [November 4, 2000](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [June 26 & 30, 2000](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [March 18, 2000](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [October 23, 1999](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [July 12 & 16, 1999](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [March 27, 1999](#), Board of Governors Meeting
 Minutes for the [November 7, 1998](#), Board of Governors Meeting

Link 5 in a browser: the Society's 2003 "Minutes of Board of Governors Meetings" page.

Tip: open these in a private browser window to show that no login or saved session is involved.

The public record at a glance

106

Board meetings with publicly posted minutes, 1996–2026

122

minutes files, counting every posted version

57

Board agendas

340

officer, division and committee reports attached to meetings

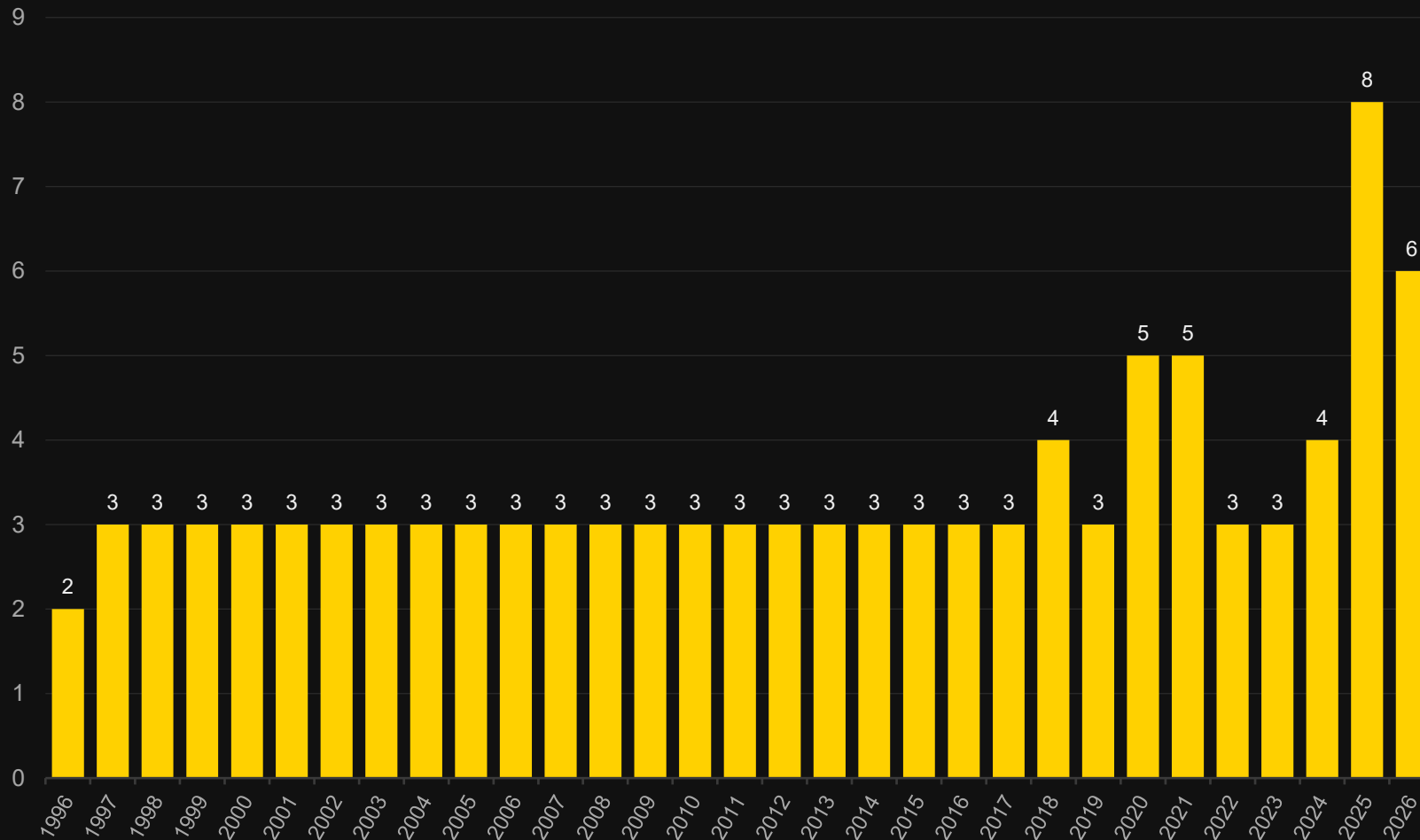
1,076

governance documents: Board Manuals, Bylaws, Acts, policies

31

calendar years covered

Meetings with public minutes, by year



Let's look at...

[2005 → 3 meetings](#)

[2020 → 5 meetings](#)

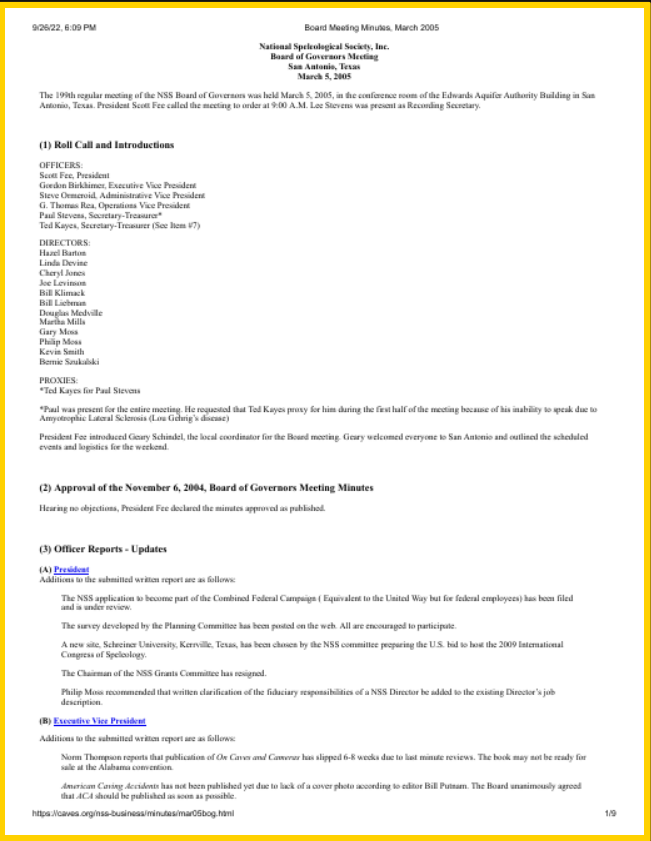
[2024 → 4 meetings](#)

[2025 → 8 meetings](#)

[2026 → 6 meetings](#)

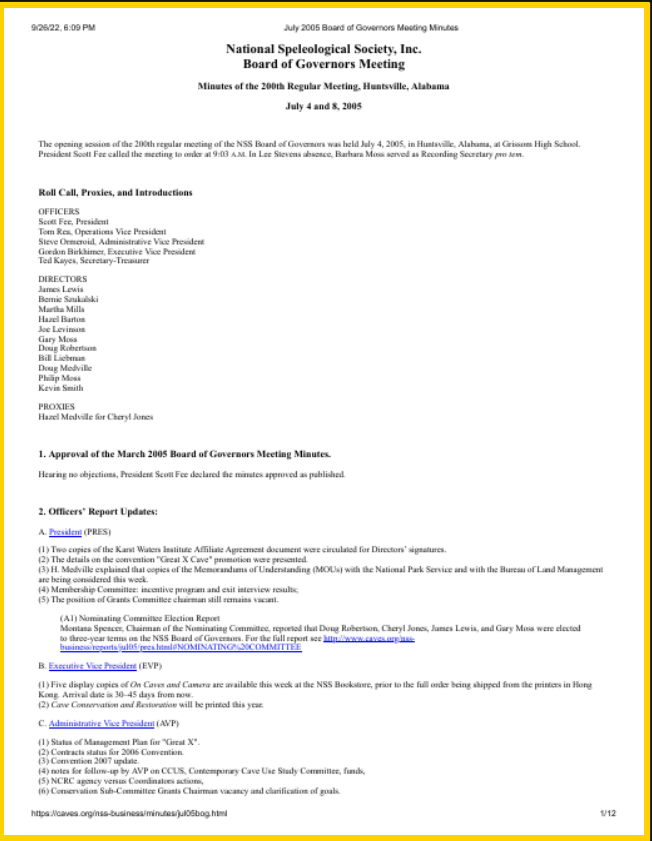
Click a year to open its minutes.

2005: the minutes themselves



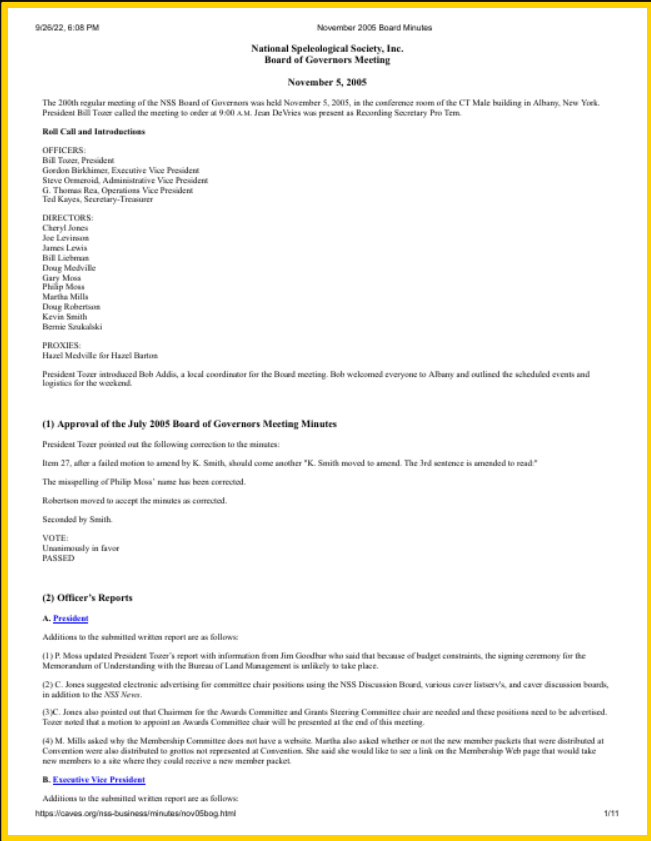
5 Mar 2005

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0503BOG.pdf>



4 Jul 2005

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0507BOG.pdf>



5 Nov 2005

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0511BOG.pdf>

2020: the minutes themselves

National Speleological Society, Inc. Special Meeting of the Board of Governors Minutes of Phone Meeting January 9, 2020 FINAL The special meeting of the NSS Board of Governors was held via teleconference on January 9, 2020. These minutes, when accompanied by corrections submitted by the Board, constitute the official record of the meeting. President Schindell called the meeting to order at 9:00 pm ET. Roll Call Officers Geary Schindell, president Katherine Crispin, administrative vice-president (AVP) Scott Engel, executive vice-president (EVP) Maureen Handler, proxy for Mark Skove, operations vice-president (OVP) Kristine Ebrey, secretary-treasurer elect (S-T) Directors Gary Barnes Nathan Farrar Pati Frantz Stephen Gladieux Savannah Sawyer Julie Schenck-Brown Carol Tideman Will Urbanski Adam Weaver Meredith Weberg Cindy Wu 1) Approval of the minutes of the Fall 2019 Board of Governors Meeting in Huntsville, AL. Schindell moved: The minutes from the November 9, 2019 NSS Board of Governors meeting held in Huntsville, Alabama are approved, with updates from Weberg email of 1/8/2020. NOTE: Unanimous PASSED 2) Confirmation of Chair of the Membership Committee Schindell moved: Kim Fedrick is confirmed as the chair of the Membership Committee. NSS Board Meeting Minutes Page 1 January 2020 v1	National Speleological Society, Inc. Board of Governors Meeting Minutes of the 244th Regular Meeting Wind Cave, South Dakota March 7, 2020 FINAL The 244th regular meeting of the Board of Governors (BOG) was held at Wind Cave, South Dakota. These minutes, when accompanied by corrections submitted by the Board, constitute the official record of the meeting. President Geary Schindell called the meeting to order at 9:02 a.m. and welcomed everyone in attendance. Margie Geisler was present as recording secretary. Call to Order and Roll Call Officers Geary Schindell, President (PRES) Maureen Handler, Operations Vice-President (OVP) Kat Crispin, Administrative Vice-President (AVP) Scott Engel, Executive Vice-President (EVP) Kristine Ebrey, Secretary-Treasurer (S-T) Directors Gary Barnes Nathan Farrar (via Zoom) Pati Frantz Stephen Gladieux Savannah Sawyer Julie Schenck-Brown Carol Tideman Will Urbanski Adam Weaver Meredith Hall Weberg Cindy Wu Guests Michelle Wheatley, Superintendent of Jewel Cave Misty Anderson, District Manager of Black Hills National Forest Mike Lounds, Jewel Cave Resource Management Dave Thomas, Acting Superintendent of Wind Cave Rich Geisler, 2020 NSS Convention Chair Guests: Forty-five guests were logged into the BOG Virtual Zoom Meeting 1) Officer Reports: a. President (PRES) – Geary Schindell President Schindell thanked Gary Barnes, Pati Frantz, Savannah Sawyer, and Will Urbanski for their service as board members. Kristine Ebrey stepped down as a director and was appointed as the NSS Secretary-Treasurer at the March 2020 meeting. New NSS Board Minutes v3 Page 1 March 2020	National Speleological Society, Inc. Board of Governors Meeting Minutes of the 245th Regular Meeting Virtual Meeting July 25 and 26, 2020 FINAL The 245th regular meeting of the Board of Governors was held virtually via Zoom. These minutes, when accompanied by corrections submitted by the Board, constitute the official record of the meeting. President Geary Schindell called the meeting to order at 10:02 a.m. and welcomed everyone in attendance. Margie Geisler was present as recording secretary. Roll Call Officers Geary Schindell, President (PRES) Maureen Handler, Operations Vice-President (OVP) Kat Crispin, Administrative Vice-President (AVP) Scott Engel, Executive Vice-President (EVP) Kristine Ebrey, Secretary-Treasurer (S-T) Directors Nick Anderson Riley Drake Nathan Farrar Stephen Gladieux Peter Johnson Sonia Meyer Julie Schenck-Brown Carol Tideman Ben Tobin Will Urbanski Meredith Weberg Cindy Wu 1) Officer & Committee Reports: There were no reports presented by the officers or committees. 2) Comments from the Audience (3-minute limit per person) No comments. NEW BUSINESS 3) Recognition of NSS Cave Preservation Network Act 50-960 Weaver Moved: The NSS Board of Governors recognize the NSS Cave Preservation Network (CPN). The CPN is a collaboration of the NSS, the National Caves Association (NCA), and numerous of private cave owners. This program is meant to preserve caves and cave access. It strives to improve NSS Board Meeting Page 1 July 2020 v4	National Speleological Society, Inc. Board of Governors Meeting Minutes of the September 30, 2020 Special Meeting September 30, 2020 FINAL The September 30 special meeting of the Board of Governors was held virtually. Call to Order and Roll Call at 8:00 PM CST Officers Geary Schindell, President (PRES) Scott Engel, Executive Vice-President (EVP) Adam Weaver, Administrative Vice-President (AVP) Maureen Handler, Operations Vice-President (OVP) Kristine Ebrey, Secretary-Treasurer (S-T) Directors Nick Anderson Riley Drake Nathan Farrar Stephen Gladieux Peter Johnson Sonia Meyer Julie Schenck-Brown Carol Tideman Ben Tobin Will Urbanski Meredith Weberg Cindy Wu 1) Officer & Committee Reports: Tideman moved to approve the minutes of the July 25 and July 26, 2020 virtual Board of Governors Meeting. Weberg seconded. 2) Comments from the Audience (3-minute limit per person) No comments. NEW BUSINESS 3) Recognition of NSS Cave Preservation Network Act 50-960 Weaver Moved: The NSS Board of Governors recognize the NSS Cave Preservation Network (CPN). The CPN is a collaboration of the NSS, the National Caves Association (NCA), and numerous of private cave owners. This program is meant to preserve caves and cave access. It strives to improve NSS Board Meeting Page 1 September 2020	National Speleological Society, Inc. Board of Governors Meeting Minutes of the 246th Regular Meeting Virtual Meeting November 7, 2020 FINAL The 246th regular meeting of the Board of Governors will be held virtually. Call to Order and Roll Call Officers Geary Schindell, President (PRES) Scott Engel, Executive Vice-President (EVP) Adam Weaver, Administrative Vice-President (AVP) Maureen Handler, Operations Vice-President (OVP) Kristine Ebrey, Secretary-Treasurer (S-T) Directors Nick Anderson Riley Drake Nathan Farrar Stephen Gladieux Peter Johnson Sonia Meyer Julie Schenck-Brown Carol Tideman Ben Tobin Will Urbanski Meredith Weberg Cindy Wu Guests: Tideman moved to approve the minutes of the July 25 and July 26, 2020 virtual Board of Governors Meeting. Weberg seconded. 1) Officer & Committee Reports: a. President (PRES) – Geary Schindell There were no additions to the President's report. b. Executive Vice President (EVP) – Scott Engel Resolution of mailing of the NSS News. Updates on books: Peter M. Haer book at NSS Board Meeting Page 1 November 7, 2020
9 Jan 2020 (special) https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2001BOG-Special.pdf	7 Mar 2020 https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2003BOG.pdf	25 Jul 2020 https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2007BOG.pdf	30 Sep 2020 (special) https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2009BOG_Special.pdf	7 Nov 2020 https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2011BOG.pdf

**National Speleological Society, Inc.
Board of Governors Meeting
Minutes of the 256th Regular Meeting
New York City, NY
March 10, 2024
FINAL**

1) **Call to Order and Roll Call - 9:12 am EST**

Officers (all present)

Directors

**National Speleological Society, Inc.
Board of Governors Meeting
Minutes of Special Exception Meeting**

Virtual
May 14, 2024
FINAL

1) **Call to Order and Roll Call**

Officers

Directors

2) Minutes to approve
➤ None

3) Officer & Committee Reports
➤ None

**National Speleological Society, Inc.
Board of Governors Meeting
Minutes of the 257th Regular Meeting**

Sewanee, TN
July 1 & 5, 2024
FINAL

1) **Call to Order and Roll Call: 9:00AM**

Directors

2) Minutes to approve -

March 10, 2024

Manning: moves

Johnson: seconds

Gladieux: calls for voice vote

Voice Vote:

UNANIMOUS APPROVAL

May 14, 2024

Tobin: moves

Johnson: seconds

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2407BOG.pdf>

**National Speleological Society, Inc.
Board of Governors Meeting
Minutes of Special Meeting**

VIRTUAL
September 30th, 2024
FINAL

1) **Call to Order and Roll Call: 8:00PM EST**

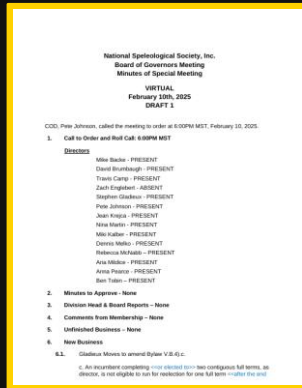
Directors

2) Comments from the Membership
NONE

3) Unfinished Business
NONE

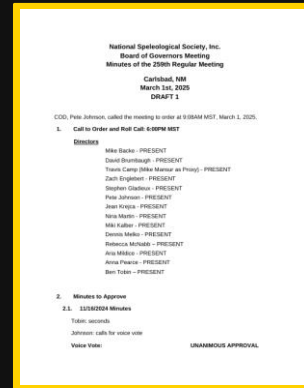
<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2409BOG.pdf>

2025: the minutes themselves



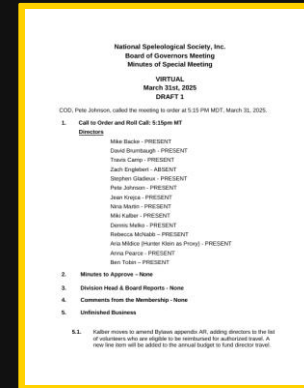
10 Feb 2025 (special)

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2502BOG_Special.docx



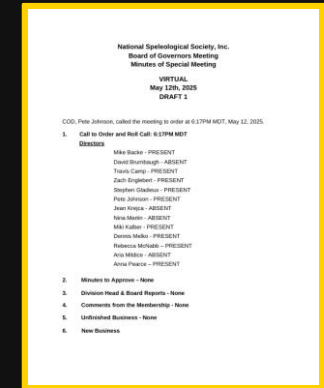
1 Mar 2025

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2503BOG.docx>



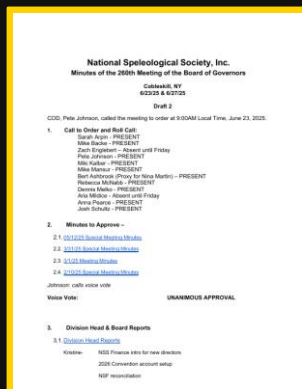
31 Mar 2025 (special)

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2503BOG_Special.docx



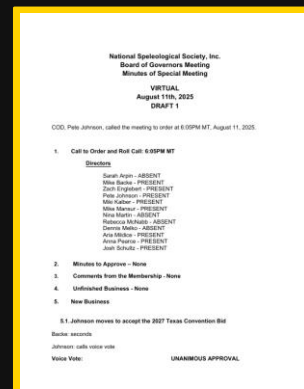
12 May 2025 (special)

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2505BOG_Special.docx



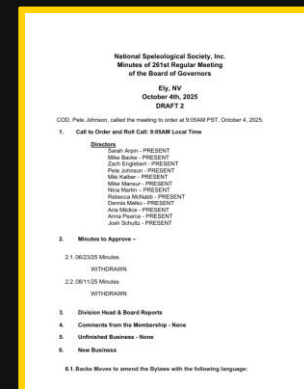
23 Jun 2025

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2506BOG.pdf>



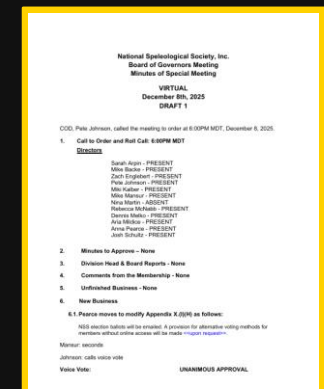
11 Aug 2025 (special)

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2508BOG.pdf>



4 Oct 2025

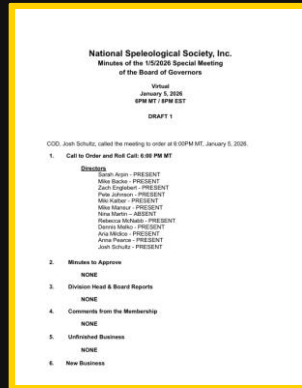
<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2510BOG.pdf>



8 Dec 2025 (special)

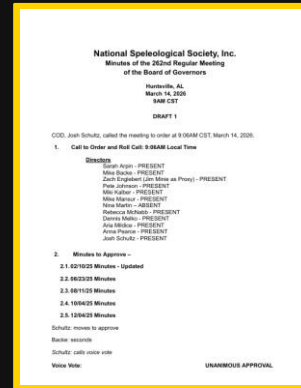
<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2512BOG.pdf>

2026: the minutes themselves



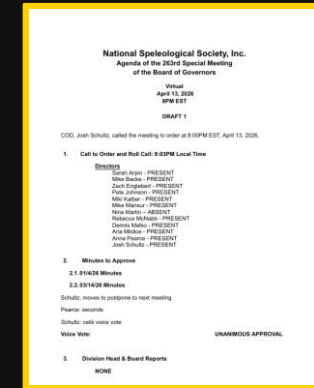
5 Jan 2026 (special)

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/1.5.2026-Minutes-Draft-1.docx.pdf>



14 Mar 2026

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/3.14.2026-Minutes-Draft-1-Updated-3.18.docx.pdf>



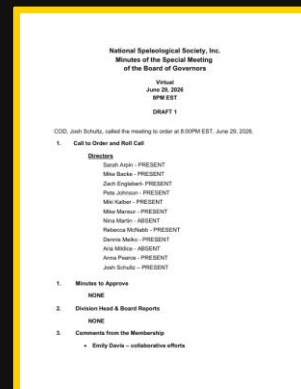
13 Apr 2026 (special)

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/4.13.2026_Minutes_Draft1.docx.pdf



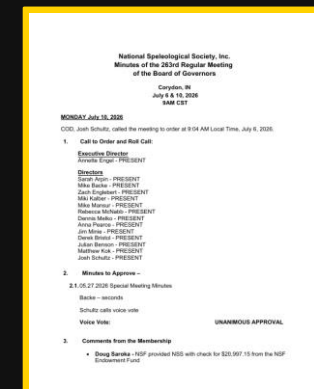
28 Apr 2026 (special)

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/4.28.2026_Minutes_Draft-1.docx.pdf



29 Jun 2026 (special)

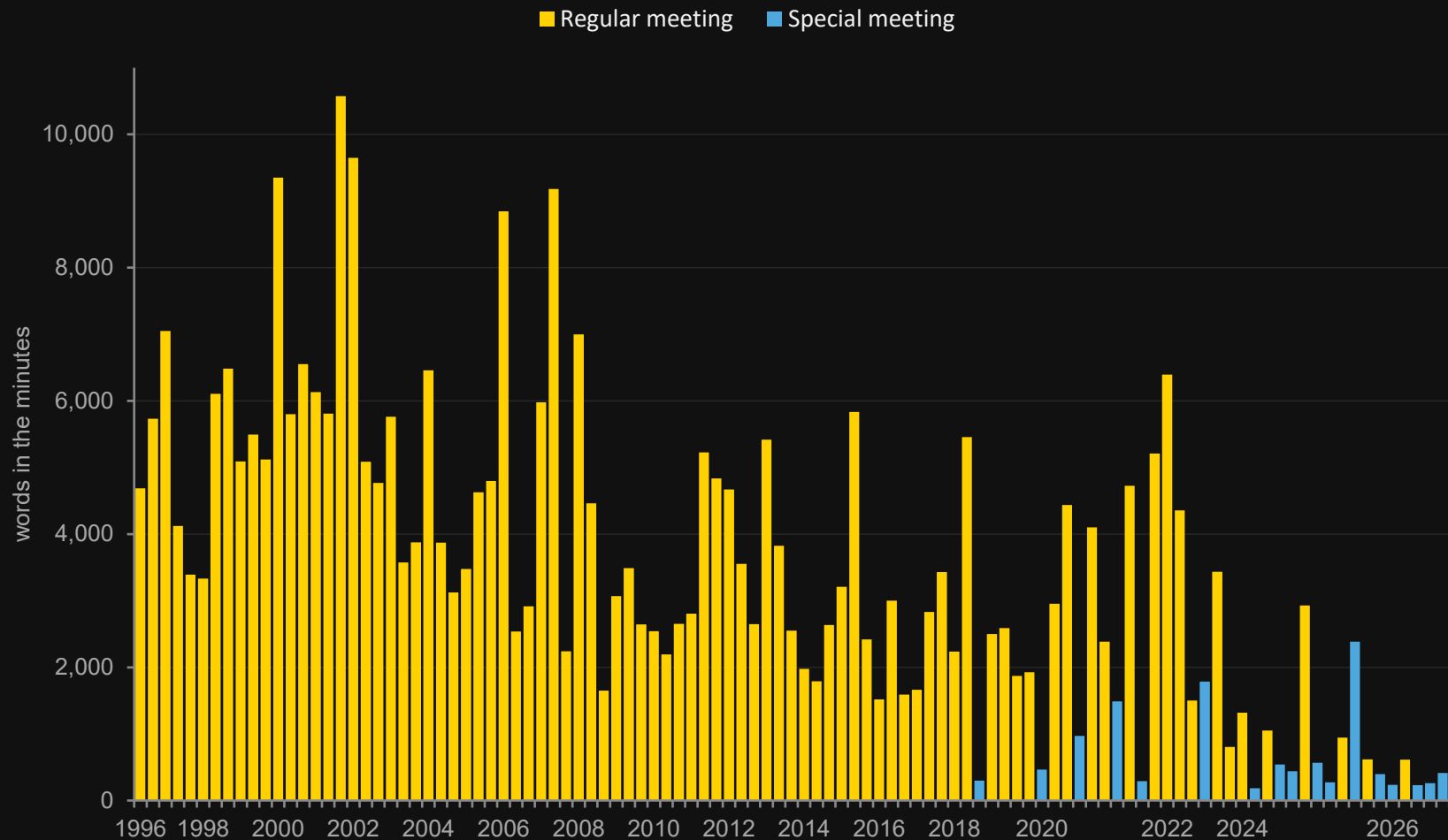
https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/2026.06.29_NSS-BoG-Special-Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf



6 Jul 2026

https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/2026.07.06_NSS-BoG-Special-Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf

How long are the minutes? Words per meeting, 1996–2026



Median words, regular meetings

5,119

1996–2005 · 29 meetings

2,992

2006–2015 · 30 meetings

2,542

2016–2026 · 30 meetings

Special meetings (17): median 415 words.

PART 1

The rules for minutes

What the Society's own governing documents require — and how those rules have changed.

A large yellow circle containing the number 1.

The current rule, in the Society's own document

superseded by a special board act.

B. The Chair of the Board will normally act as parliamentarian unless he chooses to appoint a parliamentarian to assist him. As Robert's Rules are designed to expedite the business of the meetings, board members should become familiar with them.

V. Minutes

A. Draft minutes will be distributed to Board members by the Recording Secretary as soon as possible after the meeting, preferably within 14 days. Board members will be asked to submit corrections and suggestions to the Recording Secretary within 7 days. After making all necessary corrections the Recording Secretary will submit to the Chair of the Board a copy of the comments and corrections related to the business conducted, as well as the final draft minutes for approval by the Board at the next regular meeting. The final draft will be posted to the NSS Business page of the NSS Web site as soon as possible, but no later than 30 days after the meeting. The draft version will be replaced by the final version approved at the following meeting. Only corrections relating to the content of minutes of the previous meeting will be brought before the Board for approval. The NSS recording secretary is responsible for ensuring the minutes are posted online.

B. Minutes shall include only motions; disposals of motions; other action taken; oral updates to officers' written reports; issues and comments presented during Open Discussion period; reports from the closed sessions; a list of Board members present and proxies; disclosures of conflict of interest and their deposition, and other information pertinent to the meeting and business conducted. Written reports from Division heads and committees shall be included as attachments to the minutes

caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/Board-of-Governors-Manual-2026-07-06.pdf (page 38)

"The final draft will be posted to the NSS Business page of the NSS Web site as soon as possible, but no later than 30 days after the meeting."

How sure are we this is current?

Manual edition checked	§V.A text
May/Jun 2022 (upload)	identical*
Oct 2023 (Wayback)	identical*
1 Jul 2024	identical
Sep 2025 (Wayback)	identical
Mar 2026 edition	identical
6 Jul 2026 (newest; uploaded 12 Sep 2026)	shown here

* 2022–23 say "President" where 2024+ say "Chair of the Board." No later edition was found on caves.org as of 22–23 Sep 2026. Section header: "Amended 11-9-13:21, 7-18-11:17, 3-17-07:24d+f, 3-25-06:23b, 7-12-99:25, 26."

How the 30-day rule came to be — in the Board’s own words

to 2007

Act 05-290 (Manual, 1998–99)

“Minutes of BOG meetings shall be circulated to the BOG by the Recording Secretary for comment within thirty days of the meeting.”

Summary: 30 days to circulate minutes to the Board. No web-posting requirement.

17 Mar 2007

Items 24B and 24D — passed unanimously

“The final draft and final minutes will be posted on a public area of the NSS Web site.”

Summary: Appendix J now requires web posting, with no deadline. The 30-day sentence in Act 05-290 is deleted.

Jul 2011

Item 17 — passed unanimously

“The final draft will be posted to the NSS Business page of the NSS Web site as soon as possible, but no later than 30 days after the meeting.”

Summary: the 30-day posting deadline is adopted; 30→14 days for drafts, 15→7 days for corrections.

2024 – 2026

Manuals of 1 Jul 2024 and 6 Jul 2026

“...will submit to the Chair of the Board a copy of the comments and corrections...”

Summary: “President” becomes “Chair of the Board.” The 30-day sentence is unchanged.

The motions themselves

17 March 2007 — item 24D

VOTE:
Unanimously in favor
PASSED

(24D) Jones moved: Section V.A of Appendix J is amended to read:

V. Minutes

A. Draft minutes will be distributed to <the board> <<Board>> members by the Recording Secretary as soon as possible after the meeting <<, preferably within 30 days. >> Board members <may> <<will be asked to>> submit corrections and suggestions to the Recording Secretary <before the deadline established when the draft minutes are distributed><<within 15 days>>. After making all necessary corrections the Recording Secretary will submit <<to the President>> a copy of all of the comments <the> <<and>> corrections as well as the final <<draft>> minutes <to the President> for approval <<by the Board at the next regular meeting>>. <The President will forward the final minutes to the office for duplication and distribution. > <<The <<final draft and final >> minutes will be posted on a public area on the NSS Web site. >>

Seconded by Cole.

Moss moved to amend: Insert "and" and delete "the" before the word "corrections" in the seventh sentence; insert the words "final draft and final" before the word

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0703BOG.pdf>

July 2011 — item 17 (adopted unanimously)

Luckins seconded.

VOTE:
Unanimously in favor

PASSED

17) Revised Draft Minutes Requirements

Shrewsbury moved: Appendix J, Section V.A is revised as follows:

Draft minutes will be distributed to Board members by the recording secretary as soon as possible after the meeting, preferably within <30> <<14>> days. Board members will be asked to submit corrections and suggestions to the recording secretary within <15> <<7>> days. After making all necessary corrections the recording secretary will submit to the president a copy of <all> the comments and corrections <<related to the business conducted,>> as well as the final draft minutes for approval by the Board at the next regular meeting. The final draft <and final minutes> will be posted <on a public area> <<to the NSS Business page>> of the NSS website <<as soon as possible, but no later than 30 days after the meeting. The draft version will be replaced by the final version approved at the following meeting. Only corrections relating to the content of minutes of the previous meeting will be brought before the Board for approval. The NSS recording secretary is responsible for ensuring the minutes are posted online.>>

Tideman seconded.

VOTE:
Unanimously in favor

PASSED

18) Repeal of Act 05-194 Meeting Minutes Corrections

Shrewsbury moved: Act 05-194 (Corrections) is repealed.

Tideman seconded.

VOTE:

<https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/1107BOG.pdf>

Recordings and closed sessions — quoted

Act 05-061

Manual p16

“Recordings of Board meetings should be retained until the minutes are approved by the Board. The recordings may be reviewed only by the Board members or proxies, the persons responsible for developing the written minutes, and those responsible for making the recordings. Following approval of the minutes by the NSS Board the recordings are to be destroyed.”

Summary: once minutes are approved, the recordings are destroyed.

Act 03-363

Manual p16

“A closed portion of each Board of Governors meeting will be scheduled and included in the meeting agenda.”

Summary: every Board meeting has a closed session.

Act 05-121

Manual p17

“Minutes shall include only motions; disposals of motions; other action taken; oral updates to written reports; issues and comments presented during Open Discussion period; reports from the closed sessions; a list of Board members present and proxies; disclosures of conflict of interest ...”

Summary: minutes must include reports from the closed sessions.

Open meetings and parliamentary authority — quoted

Bylaw V.E.8

Manual p10

“Any member of the Society may attend meetings of the Board of Governors and may be granted the privilege of the floor at the discretion of the Chair of the Board or their designee, but has no power to vote.”

Summary: any member may attend Board meetings.

Bylaw V.E.9

Manual p10

“Special meetings of the Board of Governors may be called at such times and places as approved by the Board of Governors. The entire membership must be sent notices as to the date, place, and purpose of any such meetings at least two weeks in advance thereof.”

Summary: two weeks’ notice of special meetings to all members.

Bylaw V.F.1

Manual p10

“Robert’s Rules of Order, as Newly Revised, governs procedures of the Board of Governors. It is the parliamentary authority for the Board of Governors.”

Summary: Robert’s Rules govern Board procedure.

Other changes to how decisions are published — quoted

Aug 1998

Bylaw IV.M before: "...that new acts are reported in the NSS NEWS." After: "The President shall see that a record is kept of all Acts and that the record is made available to at least all members of the Society."

Summary: the NSS NEWS reporting requirement was removed (final vote unanimous).

Mar–Jun 2000

"Section 7 contains 270 repealed Acts on 30 pages. ... Section 7 is definitely more suited to the web." (report accepted unanimously, June 2000)

Summary: repealed Acts moved to web-only.

May 2022

05-290 Recording Secretary: "A permanent committee known as the Recording Secretary is established in the Department of the President."

Summary: Act 05-290 does not appear in the Manuals of 1 Jul 2024 or 6 Jul 2026 (full-text search).

Jul 2026

Appendix J §V.A: "The NSS recording secretary is responsible for ensuring the minutes are posted online."

Summary: in the 6 Jul 2026 Manual, "Recording Secretary" appears only in Appendix J.

Where the minutes have lived online

Period	Where members could find the minutes	Notes	Publicly available	Available via login?
1996 – about 2008	HTML pages under caves.org/nss-business/minutes/	Captured by the Wayback Machine	Yes (Wayback)	Not checked
2008 – 2010	Section-by-section PDFs under caves.org/nss-business/bog/	Manual also published section by section	Yes (Wayback)	Not checked
20 Jun 2022	New WordPress site: older minutes re-uploaded in one batch	Original posting dates are not preserved	Yes	Not checked
2022 – 2026	Files: caves.org/wp-content/uploads/... · List: “Board Minutes” collection, caves.org/collection/board-minutes/	Newest entry: 2025-12; no 2026 minutes listed	Yes	Not checked
2024 onward	Manual introduction links “previous versions” on legacy.caves.org	That link returns HTTP 401	No (HTTP 401)	Not checked

Consequence: for meetings before mid-2022, the public record shows where minutes are today — not when they first appeared.

PART 2

Is the 30-day rule met?

Measuring the gap between each meeting and the first public copy of its minutes, 2022–2026.

A large yellow circle containing the number 2.

Before the numbers: where the dates come from

The meeting date

From the minutes:

```
"29 June 2026  
Special Meeting"
```

Start the clock on the day of the meeting.

The upload date

From caves.org's own
file index:

```
"date":  
"2026-08-16T11:33:05"
```

*Recorded by the website itself when the file was
uploaded. Public — anyone can look it up.*

The fingerprint

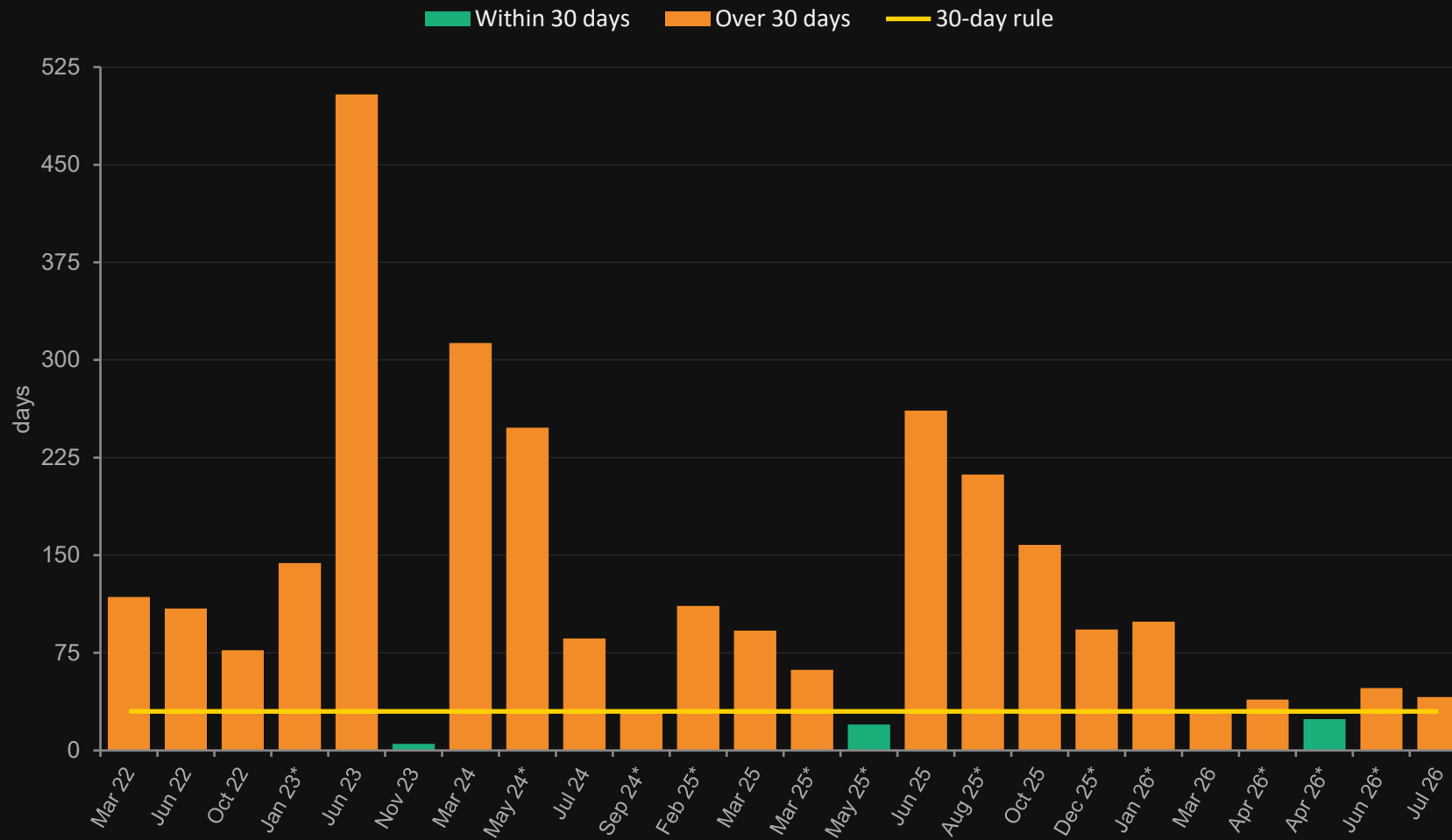
SHA-256 of the file
collected 22 Sep 2026:

```
2ce174bc52aca1ce  
5422e94a3aa10a08  
8766e8ddfc9ad5fb  
578c99ccb79a3cdc
```

*Proves which file was measured and that it is
unchanged.*

Uploaded 16 Aug = **48 days** · In the "Board Minutes" collection: **not posted as of 24 Sep** · rule: 30 days

Days from meeting to first upload of minutes to caves.org



3 of 24

uploaded within 30 days (Nov 2023, May 2025, Apr 2026) — the most generous reading

504

days — longest gap (June 2023 meeting, posted Nov 2024)

* special meeting

Source: minutes_timeliness.csv: meeting date vs earliest upload date (caves.org file index) of any minutes file; 24 meetings, Mar 2022 – Jul 2026. Upload = earliest possible public date, not a Business-page posting.

The website's “Board Minutes” collection

What it is

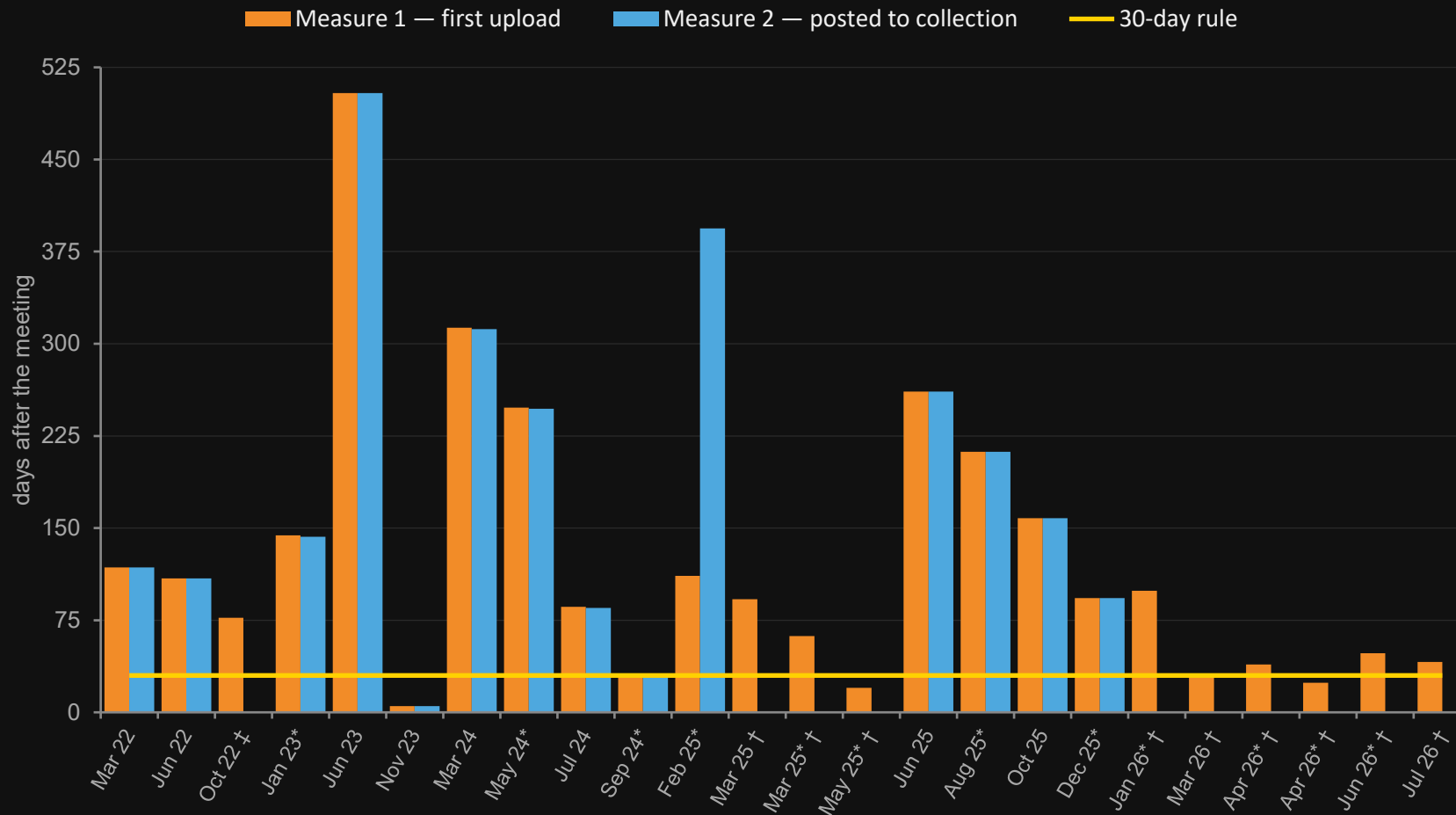
- caves.org lists Board minutes as “Business Documents” in a collection named “Board Minutes.”
- Its page, caves.org/collection/board-minutes/, opens with no login.
- Each entry has its own page and a publication date recorded by the website.
- 56 entries, the oldest for 2010. The newest is “2025-12 Board Minutes,” published 11 Mar 2026.
- This is the closest match on today's website to Appendix J's “NSS Business page.”

<https://caves.org/collection/board-minutes/>

Meeting	Posted to collection	Days
10 Mar 2024	16 Jan 2025	312
14 May 2024 *	16 Jan 2025	247
1 Jul 2024	24 Sep 2024	85
30 Sep 2024 *	31 Oct 2024	31
10 Feb 2025 *	11 Mar 2026	394
1 Mar 2025	not in collection	—
31 Mar 2025 *	not in collection	—
12 May 2025 *	not in collection	—
23 Jun 2025	11 Mar 2026	261
11 Aug 2025 *	11 Mar 2026	212
4 Oct 2025	11 Mar 2026	158
8 Dec 2025 *	11 Mar 2026	93
5 Jan 2026 *	not in collection	—
14 Mar 2026	not in collection	—
13 Apr 2026 *	not in collection	—
28 Apr 2026 *	not in collection	—
29 Jun 2026 *	not in collection	—
6 Jul 2026	not in collection	—

* special meeting

Upload vs. posting to the Board Minutes collection



1 of 24

posted to the collection within 30 days (Nov 2023)

9 of 24

not in the collection at all (†) as of 24 Sep 2026

3 of 24

uploaded within 30 days (measure 1)

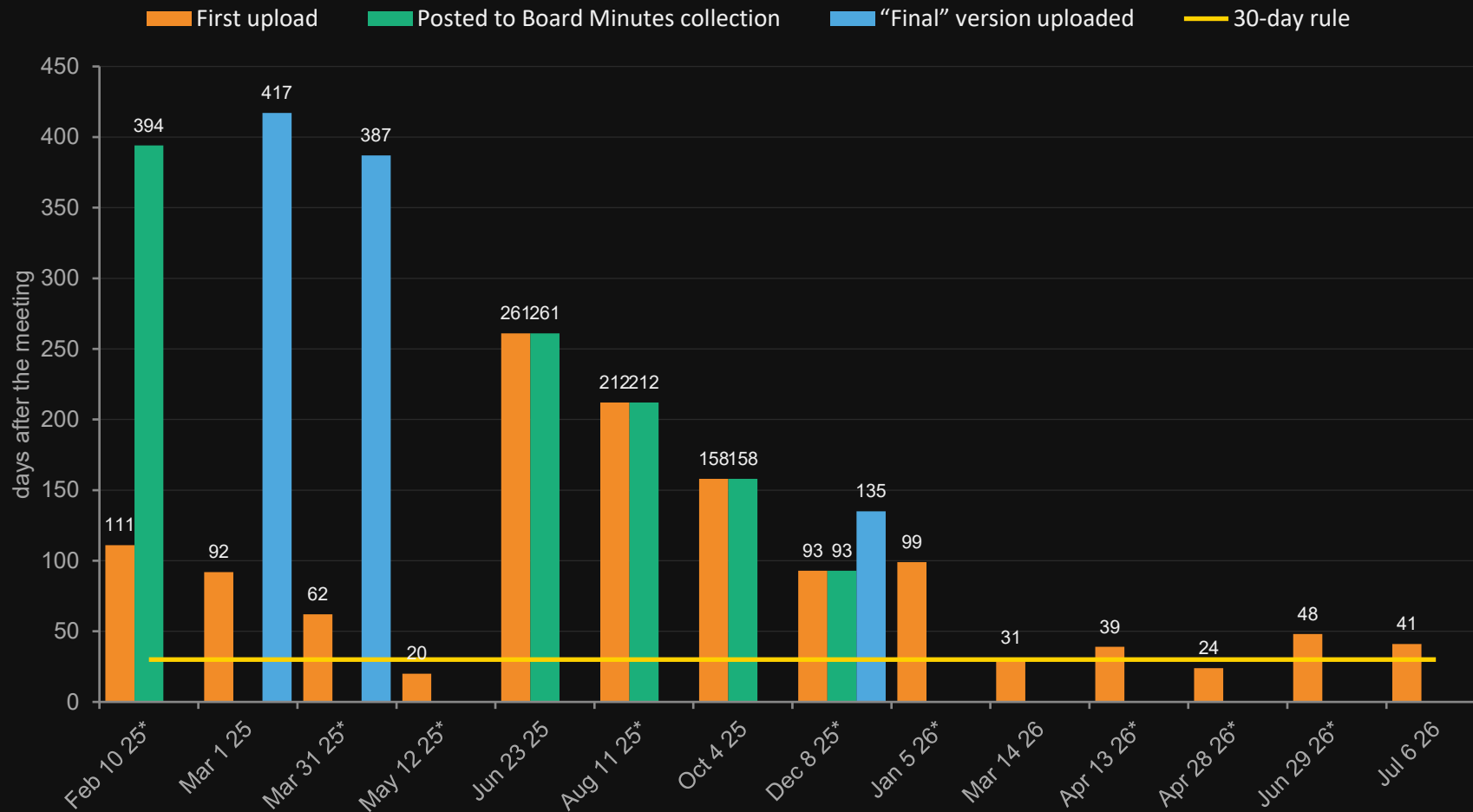
* special meeting † not in the Board Minutes collection ‡ entry created 24 Oct 2022 as the agenda, later retitled "Minutes"; date not determinable

Where the 2026 draft minutes actually appear

Draft minutes	Linked from	Event page last modified
5 Jan 2026 (Draft 1)	Event page for the 28 Apr 2026 special meeting	28 Apr 2026
14 Mar 2026 (Draft 1)	Event page for the 28 Apr 2026 special meeting	28 Apr 2026
29 Jun 2026 (Draft 1)	Event page for the 14 Sep 2026 special meeting	22 Aug 2026
6 & 10 Jul 2026 (Draft 1)	Event page for the 14 Sep 2026 special meeting	22 Aug 2026
13 Apr & 28 Apr 2026 (Draft 1)	No event page found linking them	—
Any 2026 minutes	Not in the “Board Minutes” collection	—

Summary: in 2026, draft minutes appear as materials for the next meeting — linked from that meeting’s event page, where they are listed for approval — not as postings in the Board Minutes collection.

2025–2026 up close: upload, collection posting and “Final”



2025–2026

- 14 meetings with uploaded minutes
- 2 uploaded within 30 days; 0 posted to the collection within 30 days
- 9 not in the Board Minutes collection (3 in 2025, all 6 in 2026)
- 3 have a “Final” version — posted 135 to 417 days after the meeting
- 11 of 14 have only a draft online (page 1 reads “DRAFT”)
- 2 meetings (27 May, 14 Sep 2026) have no posted minutes

* special meeting

Source: caves.org file index upload dates for every minutes file of each meeting (retrieved 22 Sep 2026)

Every 2025 meeting

Meeting	First upload	Days	Label on page 1	Board Minutes collection	Later versions
10 Feb 2025 (special)	1 Jun 2025	111	DRAFT 1	11 Mar 2026 (394 days)	PDF uploaded 11 Mar 2026 — also DRAFT 1
1 Mar 2025	1 Jun 2025	92	DRAFT 1	not in collection	FINAL uploaded 22 Apr 2026 (417 days)
31 Mar 2025 (special)	1 Jun 2025	62	DRAFT 1	not in collection	FINAL uploaded 22 Apr 2026 (387 days)
12 May 2025 (special)	1 Jun 2025	20	DRAFT 1	not in collection	none
23 Jun 2025	11 Mar 2026	261	Draft 2	11 Mar 2026 (261 days)	none
11 Aug 2025 (special)	11 Mar 2026	212	DRAFT 1	11 Mar 2026 (212 days)	none
4 Oct 2025	11 Mar 2026	158	DRAFT 2	11 Mar 2026 (158 days)	none
8 Dec 2025 (special)	11 Mar 2026	93	DRAFT 1	11 Mar 2026 (93 days)	FINAL uploaded 22 Apr 2026 (135 days)

Every 2026 meeting (through 24 September)

Meeting	First upload	Days	Label on page 1	Board Minutes collection	Later versions
5 Jan 2026 (special)	14 Apr 2026	99	DRAFT 1	not in collection	linked from 28 Apr event page
14 Mar 2026	14 Apr 2026	31	DRAFT 1	not in collection	linked from 28 Apr event page
13 Apr 2026 (special)	22 May 2026	39	DRAFT 1	not in collection	same draft re-uploaded 26 May
28 Apr 2026 (special)	22 May 2026	24	DRAFT 1	not in collection	same draft re-uploaded 26 May
27 May 2026 (special)	none found	—	—	not in collection	agenda v4 uploaded 1 day before
29 Jun 2026 (special)	16 Aug 2026	48	DRAFT 1	not in collection	linked from 14 Sep event page
6 & 10 Jul 2026	16 Aug 2026	41	DRAFT 1	not in collection	linked from 14 Sep event page; Word version 22 Aug
14 Sep 2026 (special)	none yet	10 so far	—	not in collection	due by 14 Oct 2026

What the Society told the IRS about its minutes

Form 990, Part VI, line 8a: “Did the organization contemporaneously document the meetings held or written actions undertaken during the year by the governing body?”



FY = the fiscal year the return covers, named for the year it ends (31 March). The IRS labels the same returns “tax year” 2017–2024, the year each fiscal year begins. Filing dates are the e-file submission dates recorded by the IRS. The same returns answer “No” (FY2023–25) to whether a conflict-of-interest policy, whistleblower policy and document-retention policy exist.

Part VI, line 8, exactly as filed

FY2020 (Apr 2019–Mar 2020)

IRS form year 2019 · filed May 2021

Form 990 (2019) Page 6

Part VI Governance, Management, and Disclosure. For each "Yes" response to lines 2 through 7b below, and for a "No" response to lines 8a, 8b, or 10b below, describe the circumstances, processes, or changes in Schedule O. See instructions.
Check if Schedule O contains a response or note to any line in this Part VI ☒

Section A. Governing Body and Management

8 Did the organization contemporaneously document the meetings held or written actions undertaken during the year by the following:		
a The governing body?	8a	Yes
b Each committee with authority to act on behalf of the governing body?	8b	Yes
9 Is there any officer, director, trustee, or key employee listed in Part VII, Section A, who cannot be reached at the		

https://apps.irs.gov/pub/epostcard/cor/546026867_202003_990_2021052618208242.pdf

FY2024 (Apr 2023–Mar 2024)

IRS form year 2023 · filed Jul 2024

Form 990 (2023) Page 6

Part VI Governance, Management, and Disclosure. For each "Yes" response to lines 2 through 7b below, and for a "No" response to lines 8a, 8b, or 10b below, describe the circumstances, processes, or changes in Schedule O. See instructions.
Check if Schedule O contains a response or note to any line in this Part VI ☒

Section A. Governing Body and Management

8 Did the organization contemporaneously document the meetings held or written actions undertaken during the year by the following:		
a The governing body?	8a	No
b Each committee with authority to act on behalf of the governing body?	8b	No
9 Is there any officer, director, trustee, or key employee listed in Part VII, Section A, who cannot be reached at the		

https://apps.irs.gov/pub/epostcard/cor/546026867_202403_990_2025011723013397.pdf

FY2023 (Apr 2022–Mar 2023)

IRS form year 2022 · filed Jul 2024

Form 990 (2022) Page 6

Part VI Governance, Management, and Disclosure. For each "Yes" response to lines 2 through 7b below, and for a "No" response to lines 8a, 8b, or 10b below, describe the circumstances, processes, or changes in Schedule O. See instructions.
Check if Schedule O contains a response or note to any line in this Part VI ☒

Section A. Governing Body and Management

8 Did the organization contemporaneously document the meetings held or written actions undertaken during the year by the following:		
a The governing body?	8a	No
b Each committee with authority to act on behalf of the governing body?	8b	No
9 Is there any officer, director, trustee, or key employee listed in Part VII, Section A, who cannot be reached at the		

https://apps.irs.gov/pub/epostcard/cor/546026867_202303_990_2024120622934019.pdf

FY2025 (Apr 2024–Mar 2025)

IRS form year 2024 · filed Oct 2025

Form 990 (2024) Page 6

Part VI Governance, Management, and Disclosure. For each "Yes" response to lines 2 through 7b below, and for a "No" response to lines 8a, 8b, or 10b below, describe the circumstances, processes, or changes in Schedule O. See instructions.
Check if Schedule O contains a response or note to any line in this Part VI ☐

Section A. Governing Body and Management

8 Did the organization contemporaneously document the meetings held or written actions undertaken during the year by the following:		
a The governing body?	8a	Yes
b Each committee with authority to act on behalf of the governing body?	8b	No
9 Is there any officer, director, trustee, or key employee listed in Part VII, Section A, who cannot be reached at the		

https://apps.irs.gov/pub/epostcard/cor/546026867_202503_990_2026020223878491.pdf

The form itself says: for a "No" to lines 8a or 8b, "describe the circumstances ... in Schedule O." Schedule O of the FY2023 and FY2024 returns has no entry for line 8.

Is there really no return for FY2022?

Fiscal year	Period	In IRS e-file index?	Filed (e-file)	IRS copy
FY2019	Apr 2018 – Mar 2019	Yes	Jan 2020	IRS copy ↗
FY2020	Apr 2019 – Mar 2020	Yes	May 2021	IRS copy ↗
FY2021	Apr 2020 – Mar 2021	Yes	Nov 2021	PDF link 404; XML only
FY2022	Apr 2021 – Mar 2022	No — not in any index 2021–2026	none found	none
FY2023	Apr 2022 – Mar 2023	Yes	Jul 2024	IRS copy ↗
FY2024	Apr 2023 – Mar 2024	Yes	Jul 2024	IRS copy ↗
FY2025	Apr 2024 – Mar 2025	Yes	Oct 2025	IRS copy ↗

Public records show no FY2022 return. That is not proof the IRS never received one; only the Society or the IRS can confirm.

Three cross-checks

- The same IRS index does list the National Speleological Foundation’s return for the same period (Apr 2021–Mar 2022).
- The FY2023 return’s “prior year” column repeats FY2021 figures, not FY2022.
- The Society’s own S-T report, July 2024: “Our tax return has not been filed since 2020 due to problems with the audit.” (IRS “2020” = FY2021.)

Check it live

[IRS Tax Exempt Organization Search — EIN 54-6026867](#)

[ProPublica Nonprofit Explorer — NSS](#)

Questions the record raises

?

Which page is “the NSS Business page” today, and when will minutes be posted there within 30 days?

?

Why did the FY2023 and FY2024 returns answer “No” on line 8, with no Schedule O explanation?

?

Who is responsible for posting minutes now that Act 05-290 (Recording Secretary) is gone?

?

Was a Form 990 filed for FY2022 (Apr 2021 – Mar 2022)?

?

Why are all 2026 minutes still “Draft 1,” and why are none in the Board Minutes collection?

?

Can members see previous Manual editions and repealed Acts without a login?

These are questions, not conclusions. Each follows directly from a slide in this talk.

Upcoming calls

Thu 1 Oct 2026

9:00 PM Eastern

NSS Acts and Bylaws

How the Board's rules are written, changed and published — including the 2024 restructuring that cut about 963 Acts to 135.

8:00 PM Central · 7:00 PM Mountain · 6:00 PM Pacific

Thu 8 Oct 2026

9:00 PM Eastern

NSS Financials

What the public financial record shows: budgets, Secretary-Treasurer reports, audits and IRS Form 990 filings.

8:00 PM Central · 7:00 PM Mountain · 6:00 PM Pacific

Same approach: public records only, no login, every source linked.

Check it yourself

- Every source on these slides is listed, with its web address, in the appendix.
- Minutes: caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/ and dated upload folders.
- Older versions: web.archive.org (Wayback Machine).
- IRS returns: apps.irs.gov (Tax Exempt Organization Search), EIN 54-6026867.
- The manifest of every file (URL, retrieval time, SHA-256) is available on request.



Thank you

Aaron Bird · NSS Fellow · NSS #27029 · 2dbatkv@gmail.com

Records collected 22–24 Sep 2026 (UTC). Not an official NSS presentation.

Minutes, 1998–2022

Aug 1998 minutes (Bylaw IV.M)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/9808BOG.pdf
Mar 2000 minutes (Manual report)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0003BOG.pdf
Jun 2000 minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0006BOG.pdf
Mar 2006 minutes (Acts 05-121, 05-771)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0603BOG.pdf
Aug 2008 minutes (ED vote)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/0808BOG.pdf
Jul 2011 minutes (HQ purchase)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/1107BOG.pdf
Oct 2011 minutes (agreement signed)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/1110BOG.pdf
Nov 2019 minutes (Act 12-951)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/1911BOG.pdf
Mar 2020 minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2003BOG.pdf
Nov 2020 minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2011BOG.pdf
15 Nov 2021 special (audit contract)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2111BOG_Special.pdf
Jun 2022 minutes (goals)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/09/2206BOG.pdf
Oct 2022 minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2210BOG.pdf

Minutes and agendas, 2024–2025

Mar 2024 minutes (Act 01-994)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2403BOG.pdf
Jul 2024 minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2407BOG.pdf
Sep 2024 agenda (interim listing)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardagendas/2409_NSS_BoG_Agenda.pdf
Feb 2025 minutes (offer)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2502BOG.pdf
1 Mar 2025 minutes (Final v.2)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/2025.03.01-NSS-BOG-Meeting-Minutes-Final.v.2docx.docx.pdf
31 Mar 2025 special (Final v2)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/2025.03.31-NSS-BOG-Special-Meeting-Minutes-Final.v2docx.docx.pdf
12 May 2025 special	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2505BOG_Special.docx
Oct 2025 minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2510BOG.pdf
Dec 2025 special	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/boardminutes/2512BOG.pdf
2024–25 budget	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/reports/2403/2024-2025-NSS-Budget.pdf
S-T report, Jul 2024	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/reports/2407/2407-ST.pdf
Finance report, Nov 2024	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/reports/2411/2411-Financial.pdf
Finance report, Mar 2025	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/reports/2503/2503-FInance-Report.pdf

Minutes and agendas, 2026

14 Mar 2026 draft minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/3.14.2026-Minutes-Draft-1-Updated-3_18.docx.pdf
13 Apr 2026 draft minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/4.13.2026_Minutes_Draft1.docx.pdf
27 May 2026 agenda (v4)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/0527-BoG-Agenda-4.pdf
29 Jun 2026 agenda (v3)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/2906-BoG-Agenda-3.pdf
29 Jun 2026 draft minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/2026.06.29_NSS-BoG-Special-Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf
6 & 10 Jul 2026 draft minutes	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/2026.07.06_NSS-BoG-Special-Meeting-Minutes_Draft-1.pdf
14 Sep 2026 agenda	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/0914-BoG-Special-Meeting-Agenda.pdf
17 Oct 2026 agenda	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/1017-BoG-Agenda.pdf
S-T & Interim ED report, 17 Sep 2026	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/S-T-and-Interim-ED-Report-9.17.2026.pdf
ED Annual Report, spring 2026	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/reports/2603/2603-ED-Annual-Report.pdf

Governance and context documents

Board Manual, as of 6 Jul 2026	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/Board-of-Governors-Manual-2026-07-06.pdf
Board Manual, 1 Jul 2024	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/Board-of-Governors-Manual-2024-7-1_0.0.pdf
Board Manual, May 2022	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/Board_of_Governors_Manual.pdf
Restructuring Proposal 2024-2-7	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/NSS-Restructuring-Proposal_2024-2-7.pdf
“The Case for an Executive Director”	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/p/nss/NSSExecutiveDirectorProposal_v1.pdf
ED Exploratory Committee report	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/ED-Exploratory-Committee-Report.pdf
Interim ED description (2024)	https://caves.org/wp-content/uploads/nss/openpositions/NSS%20Interim%20Executive%20Director%20Description_240526.pdf
Moran Company profile (Wayback)	https://web.archive.org/web/20241101201044/https://morancompany.com/executive-director-national-speleological-society/
NSS announcement of first ED	https://caves.org/caves/a-historic-first-the-nss-announces-its-inaugural-executive-director/
IRS e-file index 2024 (Form 990 XML)	https://apps.irs.gov/pub/epostcard/990/xml/2024/index_2024.csv
caves.org media index (discovery)	https://caves.org/wp-json/wp/v2/media